FRAMEWORK · TECHNOLOGY ASSESSMENT

How I Assess the Technology of a Financial Institution

A 7-Layer Framework

Seven layers, each scored 1–5.
Evidence beats architecture diagrams.

Vu Dinh Chung
IT Director · Banking & Financial Services · Hanoi

WHY NOT START WITH THE STACK

“The stack tells you the least. Evidence tells you the most.”

- Most assessments start with core banking, cloud, diagrams and vendor names.
- I start with seven layers — and ask for the evidence behind each one.
- Score each layer 1–5, then weight by business model.

If the strategy or the compliance layer fails, the whole assessment is capped — no matter how good the engineering is.

LAYER 1 OF 7

Strategy & Governance

01

- A technology roadmap tied to business KPIs — with a named owner and board visibility.
- A real budget cycle: CAPEX and OPEX that survives the finance committee.
- Technology decisions made at the table where strategy is set, not after it.

EVIDENCE TO ASK FOR

The roadmap · the last budget approval · the last board or exco technology update.

LAYER 2 OF 7

Architecture

02

- Can the business launch a product variant through configuration — or is every change a code war?
- Integration layer (ESB / API gateway), data model and degree of coupling.
- Core banking fit for the business model — not just for the vendor demo.

EVIDENCE TO ASK FOR

Time-to-market for the last three product launches.

LAYER 3 OF 7

Delivery Capability

03

- Release cadence, test automation and DevSecOps maturity — measured, not asserted.
- In-house versus vendor split, and the discipline of requirements (BPMN / BA practice).
- Delivery speed without structured requirements is an illusion.

EVIDENCE TO ASK FOR

12-month release history · defect escape rate · percentage of automated tests.

LAYER 4 OF 7

Operations

04

- ITIL practices in real use: incident, problem, change and capacity management.
- Uptime and MTTR trends — not a single SLA number quoted from a contract.
- Monitoring and observability that tell you what the customer is feeling.

EVIDENCE TO ASK FOR

Incident reports · MTTR trend · capacity plan · monitoring dashboards.

LAYER 5 OF 7

Resilience

05

- DC/DR design and RTO/RPO targets that the business actually understands.
- Has a real failover been executed in the last 12 months?
- A business continuity plan that lives only in a document is a liability.

EVIDENCE TO ASK FOR

The last DR test report — and the findings that came out of it.

LAYER 6 OF 7

Security & Compliance

06

- PCI DSS scope and how it is contained; SBV compliance (Circulars 09/35 and related).
- Biometric / eKYC controls, DLP and NAC coverage.
- Audit-finding closure rate — not just the number of findings.

EVIDENCE TO ASK FOR

Latest audit report · closure tracker · penetration test summary.

LAYER 7 OF 7

People & Partners

07

- Team structure and seniority; key-person risk in critical roles.
- Vendor and SLA management: what happens the day you want to leave each other?
- In this market the scarce resource is not technology — it is people who can run it.

EVIDENCE TO ASK FOR

Org chart · attrition · vendor contract map · succession plan for critical roles.

THREE RULES I APPLY

How to use this framework

01

Cap the score

A score below 3 in Strategy or Security & Compliance caps the overall assessment.

02

Ask for evidence

Architecture diagrams are aspirational; DR reports, audit findings and MTTR trends are facts.

03

Weight by model

A consumer lender, a corporate bank and a payment company are not scored with the same weights.

Comment “FRAMEWORK” to get the scoring sheet — 1–5 per layer, with weights.

Bình luận “FRAMEWORK” để nhận bảng chấm điểm.